

THE NEWS DESK PACK • ANY STORY

News Desk Day



One 45-minute routine for any news story. Pick the story, pick the frame, run the method. All ten frames share one layout, so students learn it once. On paper, with no prep beyond picking the story.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min (bell-ringer: 25)	One frame per student (Frames PDF or the typeable copy) · the story, printed, projected, or read aloud · Slides (optional) · Teacher Guide (rules p.1, scripts p.2–3, rubric p.4) · board, pens	None. It runs fully unplugged. With devices, Frames 1 and 8 can open a second source live.	Pick a story (about 10 min; Teacher Guide p.1) and its frame from the table. Print. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

ISTE 1.3.b

CCSS ELA RI.6.8

CCSS ELA W.6.1

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS Math 7.RP.A.3

On any story they are handed, students can...

- Trace a story's claims and judge which are backed by a second source. (*Frames 1, 8; rubric row "evidence"*)
- Compare who wins and who loses when technology changes, then defend a call. (*Frames 2, 3, 9; rubric "claim"*)
- Turn a price change into a percent and a cost per unit, then into a plan. (*Frames 5, 6; rubric "method followed"*)
- Say plainly why the story matters to someone their age. (*every frame's "So what?"; rubric "said plainly"*)

PICK THE FRAME — STORY TYPE → FRAME

	THE STORY IS ABOUT...	FRAME	ITS QUESTION
1	A claim that sounds too neat, or a post going viral	Fact Desk	Is it true?
2	A new app or tool that changes how people do things	The Trade	Who wins, who loses?
3	A school, city, or company setting a new rule	Write the Rule	What should the rule be?
4	A free app or site that changes owners or adds ads	Who Pays for Free?	If it's free, who pays?
5	A subscription, plan, or bundle sold in tiers	Unit Rate Receipt	Which deal is really cheaper?
6	A price going up or down	Percent Change Card	How big is the change, really?
7	An artist, game, or brand says it was copied	Copy, Style, or Person?	What got copied?
8	A study, report, or survey with a big number in it	Source Check	Who's telling me this, and why?
9	An AI helper that can use your photos or accounts	Permission Slip	What may it do on its own?
10	A theft, hack, outage, or loss	Risk Grid	What would hurt most to lose?
	People losing jobs, or a service shutting down	The Trade or Source Check	Who loses? Who says so?

OPEN — HEADLINE ONLY (5 MIN)

Show or read the headline and nothing else. Ask: **"What question does this headline make you want to ask?"** Take three answers, then name the frame: *"That's a Frame 2 question — who wins, who loses. That's today's frame."*

If nobody has a question: read the first sentence aloud and ask which word they would check. That is a Frame 1 question. *If every question is about a person:* "We frame the change, not the person. What changed?" *If their questions point to a different frame:* "Good. That's a Frame 1 question. Hold it for the Extension. Today we run Frame 2."

Hand-out (say it): "Frames out. Top box first: the story, where you saw it, the date. Then we read."

Q READ — MARK IT UP (10 MIN)

Students read the story once (printed, projected, or read aloud by you), underlining every claim they could check and circling words they don't know. Then pairs retell it in one sentence each. The partner whose first name comes first in the alphabet goes first. The retell is your check that they read it.

If the story is above their reading level: read it aloud yourself, pausing after each paragraph for a one-sentence retell from a volunteer. *If a student says "this is boring":* "Frames don't care if it's boring. They care if it's true, fair, or expensive. Which one is this?"

Transition (say it): "Story down. Frame up. Method steps in order — number one first, and don't skip to the boxes."

Q FRAME — RUN THE METHOD (20 MIN)

1. **Solo (12 min):** students work the numbered steps in order and fill the frame. Circulate with that frame's script (Teacher Guide p.2–3). Play the editor, not the answer key. Frames 3 and 4 carry the most writing, and Frames 6 and 10 the most math. On those four, run solo 16 and pair-check 4.

If a student stalls: "Which step are you on? Read it to me." The method is the help; you rarely need to add more. *If a pair finishes early:* they write the "So what?" for a different reader: a parent, a gamer, a shop owner.

Transition: "Swap frames. Read their evidence, not their answer. Alphabet-first partner asks first, then switch. Ask one question they can't dodge."

2. **Pair-check (8 min):** partners swap frames and read each other's evidence. The alphabet-first partner asks one question and gets an answer, then the other partner does the same. At your signal, frames go back and students fix one thing. The two-line "So what?" is written last, solo.

If partners just say "looks good": "Point at their weakest step. Ask about that one." *If an odd number:* a group of three passes frames one seat left. Each reads one frame and asks its owner one question, alphabet-first first.

Transition: "Pens down. Frames face up. Share-out is one line each: your call, and the evidence behind it."

Q SHARE-OUT — ONE LINE EACH (10 MIN)

Round the room by pairs. Each pair gives one line: their call, plus the one piece of evidence behind it. Tally the calls on the board (for Frames 5, 7, and 8, the most-picked option, line, or trust call). 15 pairs at 35 seconds fit 30 students into 9 minutes. Close: **"The story changes every week. The method doesn't."** Collect frames. The "So what?" lines are the exit ticket (rubric, Teacher Guide p.4).

If two pairs disagree: score the evidence, not the answer. "Who named a source, followed a step, and said it plainly? That pair wins the round." *If time runs short:* take one pair per tally column, then collect.

BELL-RINGER — 25 MIN

Open 2 — headline only; one question from the room, you name the frame. **Read 5** — you read the story aloud once; one volunteer retells it. **Frame 15** — solo, no pair-check; steps in order, "So what?" last. **Share-out 3** — three volunteers, one line each. Collect; same rubric.

If 15 minutes is not enough: Frames 3, 4, 6, and 10 are the long ones. For a bell-ringer, run Frames 1, 2, 7, 8, or 9.

DIFFERENTIATION

- **Support:** Start with Frame 7 (mostly check boxes) or Frame 9 (short reasons). Use the "Need a start?" sentence frames on Frames 3, 4, 7, and 9. Fill the story slot on the board together.
- **ELL:** Read the story aloud twice; pairs retell before anyone writes. Pre-teach four words: claim, source, verdict, percent. Students draft the "So what?" in the language they think in best, then write it in English.
- **Extension:** Run a second frame from the table that also fits the story. Checked ONLY WITH A RULE on Frame 2? The next frame is Frame 3. One sentence: what did the second frame show that the first missed?
- **No-device classrooms:** Built in. For Frame 1, read the story aloud, then read the second outlet's opening lines aloud. That is the room's second source. **With devices:** Frames 1 and 8 open sources live; Frames 5 and 6 use a calculator.